In an effort to prop up the economy, on 22 October 1993, Mobutu demonetized the old zaire, replacing it with the New Zaire (NZ) at a rate of NZ 1= Z3 million, with an initial parity of NZ 3 per US$ 1.

Prof. Hughes Leclercq reports that the demonetization backfired, with '…soldiers refusing to accept the new notes in salary payments leading to renewed rioting. The new currency depreciated sharply, sending prices into a further sharp upward spiral. By December 1993, the NZ had depreciated to 102 per US$ 1, and monthly inflation had surged to 250 per cent, yielding cumulative price increases that exceeded 3,300 per cent during the three-month period ending in January 1994.'

In his article in *The New York Times*, Kenneth Noble quotes a number of people who summed up the situation. Peter Rosenblum, a senior lawyer with the Human Rights Law Group, said, 'Zairians are in terror of the new bills. They know that each time a new bill is introduced, the old bills become virtually worthless, and inflation takes another galactic leap.'

Etienne Tshisekedi, Zaire's main opposition leader at the time, called the demonetization a 'criminal swindle and pure piracy.' In Washington, George Moose, the Assistant Secretary for African Affairs, said at a Congressional hearing that the Mobutu government's currency manipulations were '…wrong-headed and could incite a new round of pillaging and military unrest.'

These words were to prove prophetic. As the economy collapsed, ethnic violence increased and in May 1997, Laurent Kabila, who had led a popular rebellion against Mobutu, seized power, declared himself President, and renamed Zaire as the Democratic Republic of the Congo. Mobutu fled into exile in Morocco and died four months later.

North Korea[19]

Korea, which had been annexed by Japan in 1910, was liberated in 1945 at the end of World War II. The country was divided into two